

GRE Preparation Resource Guide

A structured collection of trusted resources — from first study session to test day.

01 Core Resources — Must-Have

ETS Official GRE Website

Free +
Paid

The official source. Contains the exact test format, scoring details, official prep materials, and two free full-length practice tests. Start here before anything else.

<https://www.ets.org/gre>

The Official GRE Guide (ETS)

Paid

The most authentic prep book available. Written by the test makers themselves — includes real retired GRE questions. Essential for understanding how questions are actually structured.

<https://www.ets.org/gre/test-takers/general-test/prepare/materials/official-guide.html>

Magoosh GRE Blog

Free

One of the best free hubs for GRE strategy articles, study schedules, and vocabulary lists. Even without their premium course, the blog alone is incredibly useful.

<https://magoosh.com/gre>

Manhattan Prep GRE 6 lb. Book

Paid

Over 1,800 practice problems across all GRE topics. Great for drilling once you've covered the basics. Very thorough coverage of quant and verbal question types.

<https://www.manhattanprep.com/gre/books>

02 Quant Preparation

ETS Official Math Review

Free

A free PDF from ETS that covers all math topics tested on the GRE. Perfect for identifying gaps in your knowledge before you start practicing questions.

<https://www.ets.org/content/dam/ets-org/pdfs/gre/gre-math-review.pdf>

Manhattan Prep GRE Quant Foundations

Paid

Best for those who feel rusty on math fundamentals. Covers arithmetic through algebra at a digestible pace before tackling harder GRE-level problems.

<https://www.manhattanprep.com/gre/books/gre-math-foundations>

Magoosh GRE Math Lessons

Paid

Video-based lessons taught by instructors who explain the logic behind each problem type. Adaptive platform identifies your weak spots and targets them. Great for visual learners.

<https://gre.magoosh.com>

Khan Academy (Math Refresher)

Free

Not GRE-specific, but excellent for brushing up on algebra, geometry, and data interpretation. Use it alongside GRE prep if your math foundation needs strengthening.

<https://www.khanacademy.org/math>

03 Verbal & Vocabulary

Manhattan Prep 500 Essential GRE Words

Paid

500 essential GRE words organized into engaging flashcard-style groups. Focuses on words that actually appear on the test — one of the most strategic vocabulary resources.

<https://www.manhattanprep.com/gre/books/500-essential-words>

Magoosh GRE Vocabulary Flashcards

Free

Over 1,000 GRE vocabulary flashcards, completely free. Available on the web and as an app. Great for daily vocabulary review on the go.

<https://gre.magoosh.com/flashcards/vocabulary>

The Princeton Review GRE Verbal Workout

Paid

Focused entirely on verbal reasoning strategies — text completion, sentence equivalence, and reading comprehension. Excellent for learning how to approach GRE verbal questions methodically.

<https://www.princetonreview.com/grad/gre-prep>

Vocabulary.com

Free

A free adaptive vocabulary-learning platform. Search for a 'GRE word list' to get started. Makes vocabulary building engaging through quizzes and real-world context.

<https://www.vocabulary.com>

04 Practice Tests

ETS PowerPrep (Tests 1 & 2)

Free

The two most important practice tests you can take. Built by ETS using the same engine as the real GRE. Your scores here are the most reliable predictor of your actual test performance.

<https://www.ets.org/gre/test-takers/general-test/prepare/powerprep.html>

ETS PowerPrep Plus (Tests 3, 4, 5)

Paid

Three additional full-length tests from ETS using real retired questions. Worth the cost (~\$39.99 each) as test day approaches. Highest fidelity outside of the actual exam.

<https://www.ets.org/gre/test-takers/general-test/prepare/powerprep-online.html>

Manhattan Prep Practice Tests

Paid

Six computer-adaptive practice tests. Known for being slightly harder than the real GRE — good for building confidence. One test is free to try.

<https://www.manhattanprep.com/gre/free-gre-practice-test>

Magoosh Practice Tests

Paid

Includes full-length practice tests with detailed explanations for every answer. The adaptive diagnostic helps you see exactly where you need to improve.

<https://gre.magoosh.com>

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Advanced Resources — For High Scorers

GregMat+

Paid

Highly popular among students aiming for 160+. Efficient and strategic teaching style with structured schedules and a very active community. Excellent value.

<https://www.gregmat.com>

Manhattan Prep 5 lb. Quant Deep Dives

Paid

For students targeting 165+ on Quant. Provides harder-than-average problems with detailed strategic walkthroughs. Helps expose subtle traps in GRE question design.

<https://www.manhattanprep.com/gre/books>

GRE Tutor — The Princeton Review

Paid

One-on-one tutoring from experienced GRE instructors. Best for students with specific weak areas that self-study hasn't resolved. Expensive but highly effective for targeted improvement.

<https://www.princetonreview.com/grad/gre-tutoring>

r/GRE Community (Reddit)

Free

A large, active community where high scorers share study plans, debrief their test experience, and recommend resources. Great for motivation and peer-tested strategies.

<https://www.reddit.com/r/GRE>

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Free Resources — Quick Reference

ETS PowerPrep Tests 1 & 2

<https://www.ets.org/gre/test-takers/general-test/prepare/powerprep.html>

ETS Official Math Review (PDF)

<https://www.ets.org/content/dam/ets-org/pdfs/gre/gre-math-review.pdf>

Magoosh GRE Blog & Flashcards	https://magoosh.com/gre
Khan Academy Math	https://www.khanacademy.org/math
GregMat Free YouTube Channel	https://www.youtube.com/@GregMat
Vocabulary.com	https://www.vocabulary.com

07 How to Use These Resources

- 01 Take ETS PowerPrep Test 1 before studying anything. This gives you a baseline score and shows exactly where to focus.
- 02 Review the ETS Math Review PDF and Magoosh's blog to understand the test structure and all content areas. Don't skip this step.
- 03 Pick one primary resource for Quant and one for Verbal, and stick with it consistently rather than jumping between five different books.
- 04 Build vocabulary daily — even 10-15 minutes with Magoosh flashcards or Vocabulary.com adds up significantly over weeks.
- 05 Save PowerPrep Test 2 and PowerPrep Plus tests for the final 2-3 weeks before your exam. Use them as realistic simulations under timed conditions.
- 06 After every practice test, spend more time reviewing wrong answers than taking new tests. Understanding why you got something wrong is what drives score improvement.
- 07 If you're aiming for 160+ on either section, consider GregMat+ or a Princeton Review tutor for targeted advanced coaching.

Good luck with your GRE preparation! Consistency and reviewing mistakes are the two biggest drivers of score improvement.